

BLUEBERRIES *Vaccinium corymbosum*

Deliciously sweet and packed with vitamins and antioxidants, blueberries are often described as a “superfood.” Eaten fresh, cooked in pies, or used to make jams and jellies, they will not disappoint. Grow at least two or three plants to ensure effective pollination and high yields, and buy two- or three-year-old plants if possible, since blueberries do not reach their full cropping potential until they are about five years old.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Container-grown plants will establish more readily than bare-root types, but ensure that they have not become pot-bound. Plant both types between late fall and early spring, as long as the ground is not frozen. Blueberries need an acidic soil in order to thrive—a pH of between 4 and 5.5—so, if necessary, prepare your soil in advance, or plant in a container, where you can easily control the growing conditions.

Most blueberries are self-fertile, but like most crops their yield is increased and improved if they are pollinated by another variety. Plant in a sheltered location, protected from strong winds, with plenty of sunshine in the summer months.



Protect the pretty flowers against frost.

CROP CARE

If plants flower early in spring they may need protection against frost; use horticultural fleece, or bring container-grown plants under cover. Blueberries need a lot of water during growth, but use rainwater in order to maintain acidic soil conditions. Mulch around plants with bark or pine needles, and apply a balanced fertilizer after pruning.